

ACTIVITY 1: Security – What Does It Mean Today? (Extended Facilitator Version)

Objective:

- Help participants understand that security has many dimensions, not only a military one.
- Draw on participants' life experiences as a starting point for further work.
- Create a shared 'map of associations' that will serve as a basis for later activities.

Description:

This activity is a moderated discussion combined with elements of brainstorming.

Its aim is to show that the concept of security is broad and personal, while also being connected to political and European-level decisions.

Facilitator Instructions (Step by Step)

Step 1: Opening the topic (2–3 min)

Say:

“Before we start talking about armies and Europe, let us pause for a moment and consider a basic question: what does security mean to us?”

Ask:

“What gives you a sense of security today?”

Step 2: Gathering spontaneous responses (5–7 min)

Encourage participants to give short answers (one or two sentences).

Write responses on the board without commenting on or evaluating them.

If the group is quiet, suggest examples:

- Peace in the country
- Absence of war
- Stable income
- Health
- Family and loved ones
- Predictability of the future
- A functioning state

Step 3: Organizing responses (5 min)

Say:

“Let us see whether we can organize these ideas.”

Divide responses into categories:

1. Military Security

- War / peace
- Armed forces
- Borders

2. Social and Economic Security

- Pensions
- Health care
- Prices
- Employment

3. Personal Security

- Health
- Family
- Everyday life

4. Stability and Predictability

- Lack of chaos
- Trust in public institutions
- Clear rules

Emphasize:

“As we can see, security is not only about the military—it is also about our everyday lives.”

Step 4: Deepening reflection (5 min)

Ask:

- “Are all these elements connected?”
- “Can people feel secure if one of them fails?”
- “Does the security of a country today depend only on itself?”

Allow a short exchange of opinions.

Step 5: Introducing the European dimension (3–4 min)

Say:

“Today many of these issues no longer depend on just one country. Many decisions are made jointly across Europe.”

Ask:

“Do you think cooperation between countries increases security or makes it more complicated?”

Collect several responses without evaluating them.

Step 6: Bridge to the workshop topic (2 min)

Say:

“If security is such a broad concept, the question arises:
How should Europe provide security today?
And should it do so together or separately?”

Add:

“One of the ideas currently being discussed is the creation of a common European Union army.”

Step 7: Closing the activity (1 min)

Say:

“In a moment we will look at this idea more closely and examine the dilemmas connected with it.”

Duration:
20 minutes

ACTIVITY 2: Introduction to the Idea of a Common EU Army (Extended Facilitator Version)

Objective:

- Provide basic knowledge in an accessible and structured way.
- Prepare participants for participation in the decision-making game.
- Introduce the main dilemmas without suggesting a single “correct” answer.

Description:

This activity takes the form of a short interactive mini-lecture combined with questions for participants.

Its purpose is to establish a shared understanding of the topic so that everyone can consciously participate in the workshop.

Facilitator Instructions (Step by Step)

Step 1: Smooth transition from the previous activity (2–3 min)

Say:

“A moment ago we discussed what security means. Now let us look at how Europe approaches this issue and where the idea of a common army comes from.”

Step 2: What is defense cooperation in the EU? (3–4 min)

Explain in simple language:

“The countries of the European Union have their own armed forces. Each country is responsible for its own security.

At the same time, however, they increasingly cooperate. For example:

- They conduct joint exercises.
- They purchase equipment together.
- They jointly plan operations.”

Ask the group:

“Do you think cooperation between countries increases security?”

(Collect 2–3 short responses without developing the discussion yet.)

Step 3: What could a common EU army be? (4–5 min)

Say:

“When we talk about a common EU army, we are not talking about something that already exists. It is rather an idea for the future that is being discussed.”

Explain with examples:

“It can be understood in different ways:

- As very close cooperation between national armies.
- As a single common military structure.
- Or as something in between.”

Use a simple comparison:

“It is a bit like a family—you can live separately and help one another, or live together and organize everything jointly.”

Step 4: Why does this idea appear at all? (3 min)

Say:

“This topic keeps returning because:

- The world is becoming less predictable.
- New threats are emerging.
- The question arises whether Europe can act together in times of crisis.”

You may ask:

“Do you think Europe should rely more on itself or on cooperation with others?”

Step 5: Key dilemmas (most important part – 5–6 min)

Write four terms on the board:

SECURITY – COSTS – SOVEREIGNTY – DECISIONS

Discuss each one briefly:

1. Security

“Would a common army increase security, or would it make rapid action more difficult?”

2. Costs

“The military requires significant spending. The question is:

Who pays, and could this affect other areas such as healthcare or pensions?”

3. Sovereignty

“Would countries be willing to give up part of their control over their own armed forces?”

4. Decisions

“Who decides when the military is used?

One country? All countries together?

What happens if they disagree?”

Step 6: Check understanding (2 min)

Ask:

“Which of these issues seems the most difficult or the most important to you?”

Invite 2–3 responses.

Step 7: Transition to the game (1 min)

Say:

“In a moment you will try making these kinds of decisions yourselves—exactly in these areas. We will see how difficult this can be in practice.”

Duration:

Approximately 20 minutes